

and grandson of professional musicians. Taught music at home, he moved with his family from Dublin to London in 1793. There he became a pupil of pianist-composer Muzio Clementi and a salesman for Clementi pianos. In 1802–1803 he traveled with Clementi to Europe, settling in St. Petersburg. Field lived in Russia for the remainder of his life and his music was influenced by Russian folk songs. As a pianist he was noted for his intimate style and singing tone. His compositions included seven piano concertos and 16 “Nocturnes,” a genre that he invented. His expressive melodies and chromatic harmonies influenced many Romantic composers, most notably Chopin. In his private life, Field was slovenly and dissolute. He drank heavily and fathered an illegitimate child. His marriage to pianist Adelaide Percheron did not last. Having suffered from cancer for several years, he died in Moscow in 1837.

KEY WORKS: Three Piano Sonatas, 1801; Piano Concerto No. 2 in A-flat major, 1811; Nocturnes Nos. 1–3, 1812; Nocturnes Nos. 4–5, 1817

Carl Maria von Weber

1786–1826, GERMAN

Renowned as the founder of German Romantic opera, Weber